

← ↺ ☆ AI Studio chat data is not purged from backend after Drive file deletion

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Bug

P2

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No update yet.

📄 DESCRIPTION

György Istókovichs created issue [#1](#)

Sep 5, 2026 07:18AM

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Description

Google AI Studio "Delete" function fails to execute server-side data purging (GDPR Article 17 Violation).When a user triggers the "Delete" command on a prompt/chat session within the Google AI Studio user interface and subsequently empties the Google Drive Trash, the underlying personal data (prompts, conversation context, token history) is not destroyed on the backend systems (Interactions API / Project Storage).Instead, the UI merely performs a client-side disconnection by moving the front-end metadata pointer (.json file) to the Google Drive Trash. The actual conversation state remains fully active and cached on Google's persistent servers.This architecture creates a dangerous "Placebo UI" that misleads users into believing their data has been permanently erased, while Google illegally retains the data on the backend. This behavior directly contradicts the official Interactions API specification (SKILL.md), which guarantees a 1-day Time-To-Live (TTL) auto-purge for Free Tier interactions. Forensic testing proves that data remains fully retrievable even after several weeks.

Code

N/A - This is a structural cloud architecture and data lifecycle management defect. The client-side UI calls Drive.trash(file_id) but fails to send a cascading 'DELETE' or 'DROP' transaction to the Interactions API backend databases linked to the specific 'interaction_id'. In a normal system, if you throw away the shortcut, it should automatically notify the central server: "Hey, the user has deleted this chat, destroy the conversation from the server as well!". This is what is called a cascade delete.

📄

Output

Expected Output: Upon permanent deletion of the JSON pointer and emptying the trash, the server-side session should be hard-deleted. If the JSON metadata file is artificially restored via the Google Drive File Recovery tool, opening it in AI Studio should return a "404 Not Found" or a corrupted state error, confirming the backend data no longer exists.

Actual Output: Restoring the deleted JSON pointer file via the official Google Drive File Recovery tool and clicking it immediately reloads the live, operational chat session in AI Studio. 100% of the conversation memory, prompt contexts, and token histories are instantly pulled down from Google's backend servers, demonstrating that the data was never purged.

Steps

Reporter	 istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com
Type	 Bug
Priority	P2
Severity	S2
Status	Assigned
Access	Default access View
Expanded Access?	
Assignee	 vi...@google.com
Verifier	
Collaborators	 _____ ^
CC	 _____ ^ istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com Un-CC me
Code Changes	--
Pending Code Changes	--
isActionable	1
isDeveloperIssue	1
isEnglish	1
isRelatedToUserOfAI	1
qualityScore	10
status	processed

Open Google AI Studio and create a multi-turn chat session with highly specific prompt contents. Click the "Delete" button on the prompt/chat within the AI Studio user interface. Go to Google Drive, locate the associated .json pointer file in the Trash folder, and select "Empty Trash". Wait a prolonged duration (tested successfully after 5 days, and up to several weeks) to ensure any standard background replication cycles or delayed cleanup queues have elapsed. Deploy the official Google Drive File Recovery tool to resurrect the permanently discarded .json pointer file back into active Drive storage. Open Google AI Studio and click on the restored .json file. Observe that the full conversation, context window, and model states resume instantly from Google's backend servers.

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Evidence links+video:
<https://discuss.ai.google.dev/t/google-illegally-retains-customer-data-and-i-am-taking-legal-action-against-them/175294>
<https://discuss.ai.google.dev/t/intentional-corporate-fraud-how-google-lies-with-the-delete-button-in-ai-studio-proven-gdpr-violation/180350>
<https://discuss.ai.google.dev/t/comprehensive-forensic-legal-report-google-ai-studio-google-drive-systematic-data-retention-fraud-gdpr-article-17-violation/180264>

suggestedComponent	--
tagged	1
Found In	--
Targeted To	--
Verified In	--
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Show 1 additional field

COMMENTS

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György Istókovichs <istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com> [#2](#)

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Sep 5, 2026 07:23AM ⋮

<https://archive.org/details/the-google-ai-studio-delete-function-does-not-execute-data-destruction-when-a-us>



György Istókovichs <istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com> [#3](#)

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Sep 5, 2026 07:31AM ⋮

Related topics and evidentiary videos:

Caught by the Anchor: How Restoring the JSON Exposes Google's Backend Fraud

● Escalation Update: Censorship on Downstream Forums (Level1Techs)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k6YHhDpnbXk>

<https://youtu.be/LBQfNbPCxQw>

<https://youtu.be/m4U6ajKuLRO>

<https://youtu.be/8Pg-7eNPUWM>

<https://ibb.co/4R9hP1vy>

<https://ibb.co/gBR1NtqW>

<https://ibb.co/vCCHMK1f>

<https://ibb.co/DgTrG7FG>

<https://web.archive.org/web/20260827061001/https://ibb.co/4R9hP1vy>

<https://web.archive.org/web/20260827061128/https://ibb.co/gbR1NtqW>

<https://web.archive.org/web/20260827061233/https://ibb.co/vCCHMK1f>

<https://web.archive.org/web/20260827061421/https://ibb.co/DgTrG7FG>

The Double Deception: Google Lies on the AI Studio UI and Lies on the Drive UI

Forensic screenshots (authenticated timestamp: Aug 27, 2026, 07:59:17 CEST) provide undeniable visual proof that Google presents false statements across both user interfaces:

The Lie on Google Drive: When emptying the trash, Google Drive’s explicit dialog box guarantees: “The item will be permanently deleted and CANNOT BE RECOVERED LATER. This action cannot be undone.”

The Reality: This statement is factually false. Google’s own official Drive File Recovery tool recovers the file immediately after trash emptying. The Lie on Google AI Studio: The AI Studio interface explicitly claims: “Your prompt will be permanently deleted after 30 days.”

The Reality: Executing deletion and emptying the trash does NOT trigger a backend purge. The “Delete” button merely hides the client-side JSON pointer. Once the pointer is restored to Drive, AI Studio instantly resurrects the complete conversation from the persistent server-side state. Conclusion: Both user interfaces actively deceive the end user regarding the scope and permanence of data deletion, in direct violation of GDPR Article 17 (Right to Erasure) and consumer transparency laws.



György Istókovics <istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com> [#4](#) [Edit](#)

Sep 5, 2026 07:35AM ⋮

<https://archive.org/details/557281747-issue-tracker>



György Istókovics <istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com> [#5](#) [Edit](#)

Sep 5, 2026 07:47AM ⋮

This ticket represents a distinct, updated, and legally archived tracking instance. It must not be classified as a duplicate or closed without a verified backend resolution. Be advised that the complete lifecycle of this issue, along with all forensic attachments, has already been permanently preserved in third-party public digital repositories (Internet Archive). Any administrative dismissal or arbitrary closure of this file will be documented in legal proceedings as evidence of non-compliance. The evidentiary chain is locked. Do not close.



György Istókovics <istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com> [#6](#) [Edit](#)

Sep 5, 2026 07:57AM ⋮

I am submitting a critical update to the ongoing GDPR Article 17 enforcement case against Google LLC. The newly released official documentation for Google’s “Interactions API” (<https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/interactions-overview>) serves as the final “Smoking Gun” that perfectly corroborates my forensic findings and proves the deliberate nature of this data fraud.

The documentation exposes three undeniable facts:

The “Stateless” Defense is a Lie: Google officially admits that the system is stateful and stores conversations on the backend by default. Quote from the documentation: “The server uses this ID to retrieve the conversation history, saving you from having to resend the entire chat

history.” and “By default, the API stores all Interaction objects (store=true)...” This proves my claim: The Drive JSON file is merely a pointer. The actual data is actively hoarded on Google’s servers.

The AI Studio “Delete” Button is a Documented Fraud: The documentation explicitly claims: “...you can also view and manage stored interactions logs, including deletion from project storage, in AI Studio.” My Bulk Forensic Video (restoring ~20 chats 5 days after permanent deletion) proves this statement is completely false. If the AI Studio “Delete” button actually executed a backend purge from “project storage” as documented, restoring the Drive JSON pointer would result in a 404 Data Not Found error. Instead, all 20 chats instantly resurrected, proving the backend deletion command is NEVER executed by the AI Studio UI.

The Perfect Synergy with the Bugarizer Confession: This API architecture explicitly explains why the Google Security Team (Issue #552682596) closed my ticket as “Intended Behavior” and stated that data “persists on our backend systems.” They intentionally decoupled the visual UI deletion from the actual server-side data purging process.

Conclusion: Google’s own technical documentation, combined with their internal Bugarizer confession and my reproducible forensic video, provides ironclad proof that Google intentionally misleads users and actively bypasses the Right to Erasure (GDPR Article 17).

THE FATAL DOWNFALL Google has completely failed. The chain of evidence is locked. I don’t need any overpriced lawyers, nor do I need a forensic IT expert to prove this. I will crush them in court all by myself. Their overpaid corporate lawyers will stand there babbling and stammering like monkeys when I show the judge exactly how their interface guarantees destruction, while in reality, they systemically hoard and steal the data of millions of users in the background.

This complete evidentiary chain is archived and ready for court.

Sincerely, György Istókovichs (Bitu79)

<https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/interactions-overview>

<https://web.archive.org/web/20260827080748/https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/interactions-overview>



György Istókovichs <istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com> [#7](#) [Edit](#)

Sep 5, 2026 08:03AM ⋮

<https://github.com/istokovicsgyorgy79-jpg/CanusLupus/blob/main/557281747%20%20Issue%20Tracker.pdf>



557281747 - Issue Tracker.pdf



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Sep 5, 2026 07:59PM ⋮

Mass Forensic Testing (Restoration of 30 Prompts): I also verified the systemic nature of this mechanism through an extended test recorded on video. I simultaneously deleted 30 individual prompts via the AI Studio user interface, and subsequently, after emptying the Drive Trash, restored the pointer files using the official recovery tool. All 30 chat sessions reloaded immediately from Google’s servers, complete with their full context. This test statistically and technically rules out isolated anomalies and confirms systematic, large-scale server-side data retention.

https://archive.org/details/unknown_2026.09.05-19.30

**György Istókovichs** <istokovichsgyorgy79@gmail.com> [#9](#) [Edit](#)

Sep 5, 2026 08:19PM ⋮

<https://archive.ph/74nuA>**György Istókovichs** <istokovichsgyorgy79@gmail.com> [#10](#) [Edit](#)

Sep 6, 2026 07:21AM ⋮

The restored files retained their original Google Drive identifier (ID). Technically, in the event of an actual deletion (Hard Delete), the original identifier is destroyed in the file system. If this were a genuine data restoration from an archive, the system would have generated a new identifier for the recreated file, and the previous AI Studio links would have become unusable. The fact that files deleted months ago became immediately accessible under their original identifiers is technical proof that Google never deleted them (merely placing them into a hidden 'soft-delete' state), thereby violating the GDPR regulations governing permanent erasure. Because the file ID did not change and the legacy link is live again, this serves as physical proof that, despite my deletion command, Google never purged (hard deleted) the data from its active database, but merely hid it from my sight (soft delete). Google Drive did not destroy the files; it merely rendered them "invisible" on the interface, while they remained in the database the entire time. In the Google Drive file system, every newly created file or file restored from an archived backup is assigned a new, unique identifier. During my test, the file claimed to be permanently deleted preserved its original identifier (1qaEuDIPScSUunssQ-KZRdAiL1cdMivg) character-for-character following restoration. This is technical proof that upon emptying the trash, no destruction (Hard Delete) occurred; rather, the database record remained persistent within Google's systems the entire time, with only its surface visibility turned off.

<https://web.archive.org/web/20260906044247/https://d3qe71uytubmmx.cloudfront.net/original/3X/a/2/a2b7d0c6a7959096a2dabcf52e202b8d6c7695be.png>

<https://web.archive.org/web/20260906044429/https://d3qe71uytubmmx.cloudfront.net/original/3X/e/7/e7360145daf66c3177e6df099960ee978c67bf97.png>

<https://ibb.co/mrLB2pFB>

<https://ibb.co/nM0nZHp1>

Accidental deletion" does not override the law: GDPR Article 17 is a mandatory statutory rule. No company can claim, following an explicit deletion command and the emptying of the Trash, that "we retained the data on our servers just in case you deleted it accidentally," while the interface explicitly promises that the data is permanently destroyed and cannot be recovered.

The JSON is not the prompt: My key argument is precisely this: Drive and the recovery robot exclusively handle Drive files (the JSON pointer). The prompt itself, the conversational context, and the token history reside on Google's internal AI backend servers. The fact that the server-side prompt was not destroyed proves that the backend never received a deletion command, regardless of what the user does within the Drive interface.

The core of my submission is precisely that this explanation is legally untenable: protection against accidental deletion cannot be invoked to persistently retain user data in the background.

I demand that Google produce the statutory provision that legitimizes this position, as this is what they cited in IssueTracker—namely, that this behavior is intentional ("Intended Behavior"). If the company cannot prove its legal standing in this regard, then this constitutes unlawful data retention, which is fraud and data theft. The buttons explicitly promise that prompts are permanently and irrecoverably deleted. Google is lying across the board. This is not poor button copy; it is intentional fraud, as proven by me.

https://web.archive.org/web/20260906050114/https://d3qe71uytubmmx.cloudfront.net/original/3X/7/d/7d922e9e09f045fc11a138e60ec232035ff6ec20.png

https://ibb.co/GQh7vjj4

There is NO statutory exception in the GDPR that explicitly legitimizes a service provider retaining personal data on the backend for “recoverability reasons” following a permanent deletion request.

Article 17(3) of the GDPR itemizes and exhaustively lists the exceptions under which a data controller may refuse or postpone erasure. These are exclusively the following:

For exercising the right of freedom of expression and information; For compliance with a legal obligation (for example, where accounting, tax, or other statutory laws mandate that the company retain the data); For archiving purposes in the public interest, scientific or historical research purposes, or statistical purposes; On grounds of public interest in the area of public health; For the establishment, exercise, or defence of legal claims. What follows from this under the law?

“Convenience recovery” is not a legal exception: Nowhere in the statutory text of the law is there any legal basis stating that “the provider may retain the data after deletion in case the user wishes to restore it later.” The position of regulatory guidance: According to the guidelines of European data protection authorities (EDPB), temporary retention of data within backup systems until the end of a rotation cycle is only permissible if the data is rendered completely inaccessible and, under no circumstances, restored back into live, active production systems. In court, I rely precisely on this statutory absence: Google cannot produce any provision of the GDPR that permits the active backend storage of chat sessions after the issuance of a permanent deletion command and the emptying of the Trash.

https://archive.ph/P2Bpc

https://archive.ph/P2Bpc/image

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Sep 6, 2026 09:24PM ⋮

https://web.archive.org/web/20260906184745/https://d3qe71uytubmmx.cloudfront.net/original/3X/e/1/e1bf4dbbaa04f17d340b2be4f802d453e9a418f6.jpeg

https://archive.ph/AttI8

https://archive.ph/AttI8/image

https://web.archive.org/web/20260906185120/https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/logs-datasets

:one: AI Studio Docs (UI)

https://aistudio.google.com/docs/logs-datasets

This is the documentation for the web interface. This includes the “55 days”, “Drive Trash”, “greyed-out buttons”, and “billing required”.

:two: Gemini API Docs (Backend) https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/logs-datasets This is the developer API documentation. This includes “store=true”, “1-day Free Tier”, and the “Interactions API”.

:one: AI Studio docs (UI): This documentation and the interface make the user believe that if they empty the Drive Trash, the data is permanently destroyed. I proved with the File Recovery bot that this “Delete” button actually only throws away the JSON file (the pointer); it doesn’t even touch the server.

:two: Gemini API docs (Backend - The “Reality”): This is the hardcore server side, the Interactions API. Here they state in black and white the store=true parameter (meaning that by default they save everything on the server), and here they promise that the data of free (Free Tier) users is automatically deleted by the system after 1 day.

In my video evidence, 5 days passed since the deletion! If API documentation number 2 were telling the truth, and the system actually cleaned up the data of free accounts after 1 day, then my JSON files restored on the 5th day would have just thrown a “404 Not Found” error message. But that is not what happened: the chat loaded completely intact.

They lie on the UI (1st doc): They say emptying the Trash is permanent, but I proved that the backend data remains intact. They lie on the Backend API (2nd doc): They say everything is automatically deleted for free accounts after 1 day, but even after 5 days, I brought back the data in its entirety.

 **screenshot-aistudio-google-docs-logs-datasets-2026-09-06-20_45_00.png** 

927 KB [View](#) [Download](#) 



bl...@google.com <bl...@google.com> [#12](#)

Sep 7, 2026 03:12PM 

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